

322 Bkm

Communication is a noun which has its origin from the verb 'communicate' meaning 'to share'. In other words, to communicate simply means 'to share'. Sometimes we ask our selves certain questions like what is it that is to be shared? Who are those involved in the sharing? How does the sharing take place? And reaching to these questions, we simply say that what is to be shared includes information, ideas, values attitudes and feeling by human beings through various mediums. However, it should be pointed out here that human beings can only share what they have in common. Having, something in common demands cooperation and understanding among us. Thus, it is commonly said that when people in an organization are in communication, they are said to be associating and cooperating.

As a matter of fact, communication is an act which every human being indulged in. We find ourselves either consciously or unconsciously faced with the urge to give or received information, express our feelings, share ideas etc. in other words, people are naturally and constantly engaged in the action of talking, listening, writing, seeing, feeling and reacting to one another's experiences.

Communication is therefore, a very important aspect of daily living that takes place between a man and a woman, a husband and a wife, a teacher and a students, the pastor and his congregation, the government and its people, the Imam and his people, the manager and his subordinates.

Definitions of Communication by other Scholars

Peter Little (1983)

Communication is the process by which information is passed between individuals and organizations by means of previously agreed by symbols.

Fisher (1981)

According to Fisher, communication is the process by which verbal and non-verbal symbols are exchanged between two or more persons.

Mytton (1983), defined communication as interpersonal relationship, either directly or indirectly which involves the transfer of information.

Byre, B.C. (1983)

Communication is not just the giving of information, it is the giving of understandable information and receiving and understanding the message so that it can be acted upon.

Udall and Udall (1979) view communication as a process by which a person (or a group of persons) shares and impacts information to another person (or group) so that both persons (and groups) clearly understand each other.

Roger and Shoemaker (1971)

They defined communication as "the process by which messages are transferred from one source to a receiver.

Parsons (1978)

He also defines communication as "the process of exchanging ideas and feelings".

Sereno, K.K. and Mortensen D.D.

"The process by which senders and receivers of messages interact in a given social context"

Hunt (1980), He defines communication as "the sorting, selecting and sending of symbols in such a way as to help a listener perceive and receive in his own mind the meaning contained in the mind of the communicator".

Communication can therefore, be said to be a process whereby the ideas feelings, emotions, perceptions, images and opinion of a person are transmitted to another.

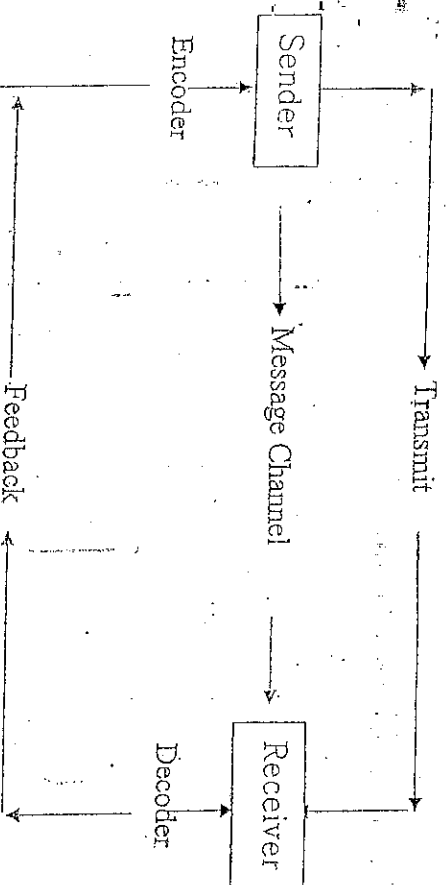
Features of Communication ✓

1. Communication entail as understanding between the sender and the receiver.
This in effect means that communication can only be effective, if the recipient can interpret the message in the way that it is intended by the sender.
2. There is the encoding and decoding process and a common tool of symbols
3. Communication can be said to entail the elements of source, message, medium channel and receiver

Process of Communication ✓

Communication is not an end in itself but a process to achieving a defined aim. In this process, there must be a chain of activities or elements that are interrelated for communication to be complete. Communication process therefore, involves the following:

- a. Sender
- b. The message
- c. The channel
- d. The receiver
- e. The feedback



The Sender

The sender (source) is the initiator of the message. He conceives of the ideas that are to be communicated, that is he encodes the message. The sender can therefore, be an individual, group or organization. The sender, perform the following functions conceive the ideas of the message, infuses meanings into the message and sends the message.

The Message

This represents the information being sent. The message can be in verbal or non-verbal forms. The eventual success of the message depends to a great extent on the choice of appropriate language.

The Channel

The channel is the medium through which the message is sent. It is the link between the source (i.e. the sender) and the receiver. The channel could be one or more of the following:

- a. Sounds waves
- b. Five sense-hearing, touching, taste, smell and seeing
- c. Letter, reports telegrams, telephone etc

The Receiver

The receiver decodes the message. The receiver also has the responsibility to receive the message, interpret, the message and reply to it. Sometimes, the receiver may find difficulties in decoding the message due to one of the following reasons: The language used by the sender is beyond the ability of his receiver to comprehend, the sender's vocabulary (words or phrases) is known to the receiver and the sender's sentence structure and use of language are too difficult for the receiver to grasp.

The Feedback

This is the response of the receiver to the message from the sender (source). This response may be through the same channel through which the message was sent. But it could also be through another channel. The aim of the feedback is to confirm to the sender that his message was received.

Purpose of Communication ✓

1. **Dissemination of Information:** Human beings use communication for the purpose of giving information to others. It is through communication that we collect, process, store and send ideas, information news, opinions and messages. Thus, to ensure the success of any organization, necessary information is passed from management to the subordinates.
2. **Expression of feelings:** Through communication, human beings express their feelings and desires, without communication, it will be impossible for us to let out our strong emotions.
3. **Imparting of knowledge:** Human beings use communication to educate others. The acquisition of necessary skills and sound character development of individuals can only be ensured through communication.
4. **Establishing Relationships:** Communication helps human beings to establish relationship with others. An effective communication within an organization brings about cordial relationship among members of that organization.
5. **Creating pleasure:** Human beings communicate in order to create pleasure for others, through signs, symbols, dances, sports, music, art, mime, human beings entertain themselves and thus make life more meaningful.
6. **Conveying orders:** Through communication, human beings give orders or directives to others. The success of organization depends to a large extent, on the effective giving and carrying out of directives from time to time by members of that organization.

Relationship between Communication and Language ✓

Language is an important tool for communication. In other words, for communication to take place there must be possession of a common language or mutual intelligibility between the parties involved. By language here, we simply mean the words, signal, gesticulations, visual display in fact all the signs and symbols by which human beings try to convey meaning to one another. So when people are communicating, there is the need for them to share and understand common signs and symbols. It is only in this way that what is communicated by one party can easily be understood by another party. It is therefore one thing to have an information to give and or one idea to share or a feeling to express. It is another way to have knowledge of the language of

the person with whom the communication is to take place. Thus, communication is to take place.

Thus, we can say that language plays a prominent role as far as communication is concerned.

Interference on Communication at Various Levels ✓

Interference on communication occurs at various levels which are as follows: (i) Phonological

(ii) Syntactic (iii) Lexical

Phonological Interference ✓

In the phonological level of language, interference occurs as a result of differences in the sound structures of two languages. This level is the most obvious area in which Nigerian speakers of English exhibit a lot of interference. Many Nigerian speakers of English tend to transfer wholly the sound features of their mother tongue into the sound characteristics that they generate in English. Thus, even without seeing them one can easily identify speaker as Yoruba speaker of English, Hausa speakers, Igbo speaker etc for example a Yoruba speaker of English will say 'si' instead of 'she', an Hausa speaker will say 'ferry' instead of 'very' etc.

Generally speaking, Nigerian users of English pronounce English sounds with Nigerian flavour. Thus, we have; 'tink' instead of 'think', 'tank' instead of 'thank', 'dose' instead of 'those', 'shunch' instead of 'church', 'faya' instead of 'fire', 'sukul' instead of 'school', 'milk' instead of 'milk', 'pila' instead of 'play', 'wit' instead of 'with' etc.

Syntactic Interference ✓

At the syntactic level, we are dealing with interference in the grammatical structure of the language used. What is grammatically correct in one language could be grammatically wrong in another language as a result of dissimilarity in the structure of the two languages. Cases of interference abound at this level.

1. Plurality
2. Adjectives
3. Word order
4. Repetition of words

Plurality ✓

Many Nigerians understand the use of "s" as a marker for regular plural nouns in English. However, they sometime over-penalize the rule. This we have:

Nigerian	British
Luggages	Luggage
Properties (belongings)	Property

Loads
 Machineries
 New slangs
 Gray hairs
 Furnitures
 Informations
 Equipments

Load
 Machinery
 new slag
 Gray hair
 Furniture
 Information
 Equipment

Adjectives

In English, some forms of the verb may be used as adjectives through the addition of 'ing' as in "a befitting burials". In Nigerian English however, we find people using adjectives as verb in certain ways. Examples;

- a. How long shall we survive on food importation (imported food).
- b. His behavior is very disgracing (disgraceful).
- c. The role of the army is defensive (defend)
- d. I was opportune to see him then (opportune moment)
- e. A matured girl will not dress like that (mature girl)
- f. The soldier sent an advanced group (advance group)
- g. You are welcomed (welcome)

Word order

In British English word order is complex, but definite forms of adjectives are used.

This is not so with Nigerian English. Thus, we have the following:

- Let us solve these common problems facing us (British)
- Let us solve these our common problems facing us (Nigerian)
- The last ten years have been very remarkable (British)
- The ten last years have been very remarkable (Nigerian)

Repetition of words

Words are often unnecessarily repeated by many Nigerians in their constructions.

Examples:

- "Give them three three minutes" instead of "Give them three minutes each"
- "They asked us to pay ten ten naira" instead of "They asked us to pay ten naira each"
- "He is fond of carrying small small girls" instead of "He is fond of carrying small girls."

Code-Mixing ✓

Code-mixing involves the mixing of the grammar of two languages while communicating.

Code-Switching

Code-switching is a linguistic term used to describe the shift of the codes of one language (native language) to another language (acquired foreign language) or vice-versa. There are two kinds of code-switching; conversational code-switching and situational code-switching.

a. Conversational Code-switching

This occurs in a situation where a speaker switches codes within a single sentence or utterance and may even do so many times. The point of switch here is determined by ease and not by linguistic constraint, e.g.

b. Situational Code-switching

Here, each point of switching corresponds to a change in situation, for instance as Edo speaker of English may have to use the word "fertilizer" in an utterance since he cannot easily find its equivalent in Edo for it so, this kind of code-switching is necessitated not by ease, but as a result of linguistic handicap.

Dissonance

Dissonance is used to describe the situation in communication in which there is absence of concord and harmony in an individual's use of language resulting in the unintelligibility of the message. This development is brought about by frequent and careless switching and mixing of codes.

ORAL PRESENTATION

PHONETICS

Phonetics simply means a scientific study of speech sound production or it can be said to refer to a set of principles and techniques for the description of speech that can be applied to any language.

Speech Organs ✓

Speech organs are articulators. They are the essential parts of the mouth, which in addition to their other functions are necessary for speech production. They include the lungs, vocal cords, larynx, the pharynx, the palate which is made up of the alveolar ridge or teeth ridge, hard palate, soft palate or velum, uvular, the lips, teeth and tongue.

(a) The Lungs

The lungs are often referred to as the power house of speech production. This is because they house the air that is used for speaking.

(b) The vocal cords

The vocal cord is situated somewhere around the larynx. These two folds of ligament and elastic tissue called vocal cords perform two basic functions in sound production.

i. By being wide open, air is allowed to escape freely. No vibration occurs. A glottal sound such as /h/ is thus formed.

ii. As the cords remain closed the expelled air forces its way through, thus causing some vibration. This vibration produces what is called "Voice" in speech.

(c) The soft palate

This serves as a gate keeper opening or choosing the oral cavity or nasal cavity. When it is hovered, thus opening the oral cavity an oral sound is produced.

(d) The tongue

The tongue is most active organ in human sound articulation. The various parts of the tongue the tip, front, blade and back are capable of forming an obstruction against the outgoing air when they come in contact with other parts of the oral cavity.

(e) The lips

The lips at times form an obstruction against the escape air or join other organs, like the upper teeth in causing obstruction which results in sound production. When the tongue is assuming different shapes in order to give some quality to the escaping air, the lip too takes part in offering additional quality to the sound produced.

(f) The teeth

The lower teeth are not directly used in speech production but if they are missing, certain sounds like /s/ and /z/ will be difficult to make. And so the two upper front teeth are the ones used in the production of the initial sound like /θ/ and /ð/ as in thin and father.

(g) Alveolar Ridge

Is the part of the palate directly behind your front teeth which forms a ridge sounds produced.

(h) Hard Palate

Is the slightly arched roof of your mouth behind the alveolar ridge, which is hard and smooth sounds produced are called palatal.

(i) Larynx

Is halfway down the front of the neck you can feel a slight cartilaginous bulge there, referred to as Adam's apple.

The Phonemes of English

Every language has a fixed number of distinctive sounds. All the sounds are particular language are its phonemes. Kat is a different word from cat because /t/ is one phoneme and /k/ is another.

Again pin and fin are different words with different meanings because /p/ and /f/ are different phonemes in English.

Phoneme

A phoneme is defined as the minimum unit of sound capable of bringing about a difference in meaning between two words. Phonemes refer to the sound system of a language not to the letters of the alphabet. To discover the number of the phonemes in words, you must first understand that word from the transcribed word; you arrive at the number of phonemes in it. For example one is transcribed as /wʌn/ so it has three phonemes; meat is transcribed as /mi:t/ so it has three phonemes. But if a sound contains as impure vowel like the following.

Impure Vowels

Waist - /weɪst/

Boat - /bəʊt/

Height - /haɪt/

Toy - /tɔɪ/

Even though the impure vowels /eɪ/, /əʊ/, /aɪ/ and /ɔɪ/ comprise two letters, they are produced as one phoneme or one sound. For this reason /weɪst/ has four phonemes /b/ ʊt/ is made up of three phonemes /haɪt/ has three phonemes, while /tɔɪ/ contains two phonemes.

Spelling	Transcription	No. of PH
Football	/fʊtˈbɔːl/	6
Dark	/dɑːk/	3
Bird	/bɜːd/	3
Student	/stjuːdnt/	6
Wander	/ˈwʌndə/	5
Poor	/puː/	2
Fuel	/fjuːəl/	4
Brother	/brʌðə/	5

The Vowel

Vowels are sounds produced without any obstruction in the mouth. English vowels are classified into pure vowels (monophthongs) and impure (diphthongs).

Pure vowels are sound produced without any movement from one part of the mouth to another, from one sound to another. All vowels are voiced. English has twelve (12) pure vowels. Seven (7) are short vowels while five are long vowels.

The Twelve (12) Pure Vowels

1. /ɪ/ as in pin, fin, tip, thin, bit pity, village, rid, with, sit, pit, coffee etc
2. /i:/ as in feel, meal, speech, key, leave, read, lead, sheep, deceive, free
3. /e/ as in feet, said, many, tense, bed, pen, hen, men, met, den, lend,
4. /æ/ as in mad, man, sad, dam, flat, bat, bad, acid, sack, bag, back, pack, etc
5. /a:/ as in pass, ask, dark, hard, march, park, part, farther etc
6. /ɒ/ as in box, got, clock, pot, odd, hostel, office, melody etc
7. /ɔ:/ as in port, fork, corn, cork, caught, record etc
8. /ʊ/ as in pull, full, put, good, should, could, would, cook, took etc
9. /u:/ as in food, mure, fuse, fool, few, fuel, woo, blue, soup etc
10. /ʌ/ as in but, some, cup, cut, love, son, above, enough etc
11. /ɜ:/ or /ɝ:/ as in girl, bird, burn, world, mercy, word etc
12. /ə/ as in father, above, about, across, admit, etc

SHORT VOWEL SOUND

LONG PURE VOWEL SOUND

- | | |
|----------|------------------|
| 1. /ɪ/ | 7. /ɔ:/ |
| 3. /e/ | 9. /u:/ |
| 4. /æ/ | 2. /i:/ |
| 6. /ə/ | 5. /a:/ |
| 10. /ʌ/ | 12. /ɜ:/ or /ɝ:/ |
| 11. /ɜ:/ | |
| 8. /ʊ/ | |

Impure Vowels

In the pronunciation of an impure vowel, there is movement from one vowel sound to another. There are eight (8) impure vowels in English. They include:

1. /eɪ/ - e plate, fate, cake, waist, say, gate, tale, age, nail, aid
2. /aɪ/ - i light, eye, guide, time, lie, height, buy, might, fight, right

3. /əʊ/ - go, home, road, pole, coke, follow, show, bone, boat, cold, grow.
4. /aɪ/ - tax, hail, raise, noise, ail, hay, evil, coin, fail.
5. /aʊ/ - cow, now, house, mouth, now, town.
6. /iə/ - steel, tear, here, dear, ear, near, peer, hear, fear.
7. /eə/ - air, share, stare, bare, deer, fair, pair, pear, spare.
8. /ʊə/ - power, sure, tour, poor, pure.

These eight (8) impure vowels can be broken into terminals.

/ɪ/ terminal	* /ʊ/ terminals	/e/ terminals
/eɪ/	/əʊ/	/iə/
/aɪ/	/aʊ/	/eə/
/ɔɪ/	/uə/	

Description of Vowels

When you describe English vowels, the following issues must be considered;

- (i) The part of the tongue involved in the sound production
- (ii) The height to which the tongue is raised.
- (iii) The shape of the lips

(i) Tongue Part

Front vowel: A vowel is described as a front vowel if, during sound production the front part of the tongue is raised towards any part of the palate e.g. the /i/, /e/, /a/ sounds.

Central vowel: A vowel is central if the part of the tongue is raised towards the roof of the mouth e.g. /ə/, /ʌ/ sounds

Back vowel: A vowel is a back one if it is the back of the tongue that is raised towards the palate during its production e.g. /u:/, /ʊ/, /ɔ:/ sounds

Tongue Height

The height to which the tongue is raised is also considered during the description of vowels. Based on tongue height, vowels are described as open, close, half close and half open.

- Open vowel: A vowel is open if the tongue is raised slightly above its normal lying position such that the space between the tongue and the roof of the mouth is wide open. The tongue assumes this position during the production of the sound /a:/.
- Half open vowel: A vowel is described as half-open when the tongue is raised a bit higher than the open position earlier described e.g. /ɔ:/ and /ʌ/ sounds.

- **Close vowels:** A sound is a close vowel if during sound production the tongue is raised so high that the space between the tongue and the palate is almost closed. This is the position of the tongue when the following words are pronounced: feet, key, and leave.

Shape of Lips.

When the lips take a rounded position as in the case of /u/ and /ʊ/ sounds during sound production, the vowel is described as rounded. If the lips are spread out as in the production of the /ɪ/ and /i:/ sounds, the vowel is described as unrounded.

Based on tongue, part, tongue height and shape of the lips English vowel can be described as follows:

	Tongue part	Height	Shape of the lips
/ʌ/	front	half-close	unrounded
/ɪ:/	front	close	unrounded
/e/	front	half-close	unrounded
/æ/	back	open	unrounded
/ɜ:/	front	half-open	rounded
/ɔ:/	front	half-open	unrounded
/ʊ/	back	half-close	rounded
/u/	back	close	rounded
/ʌ/	central	half-open	rounded
/ə/	central	half-open	unrounded
/ɜ:/	central	half-open	rounded

Consonant Sounds

These are the sounds produced with degree of obstruction in the vocal cavity (mouth). The obstruction could be "partial" or "total". The flow of air is obstructed by the lips when a consonant like /p/ is produced. The obstruction is therefore, called a total obstruction because the flow of air is completely obstructed for a while, but when a consonant like /f/ is produced, the flow of air is partially obstructed by the lower lips and the upper teeth. Thus, the obstruction here is a partial obstruction because even though the lower lips and upper teeth are in contact, air still passes through the narrow space between the lips and the teeth. The air however, passes with some frictional noise.

Consonant sounds and their examples are listed below:

/p/ as in pick, happy, put etc
 /b/ as in bus, beautiful, table
 /v/ as in pit, fat, relax etc
 /d/ as in dull, bad, loud, etc
 /k/ as in cat, kill, cut, etc
 /g/ as in get, stage, bag etc
 /f/ as in food, fill, enough etc
 /v/ as in fever, eyer, love etc
 /θ/ as in think, thank, thought etc
 /ð/ as in father, that, this etc
 /s/ as in sit, gas, swiss etc
 /z/ as in zebra, cards, business
 /ʃ/ as in fish, bush, foolish etc
 /ʒ/ as in pleasure, vision, leisure etc
 /h/ as in house, heal, prohibit etc
 /tʃ/ as in check, church, leech etc
 /dʒ/ as in judge, large, bridge etc
 /l/ as in love, ball, ball etc
 /r/ as in rice, brag, wrong etc
 /w/ as in wait, win, rewind etc
 /j/ as in yes, you, yet etc
 /m/ as in man, remain, him etc
 /n/ as in net, near, sin etc
 /ŋ/ as in sing, young, bang etc

Classification of English Consonant Sounds

Three factors are considered in the classification of consonants. These are "place of articulation", "manner of articulation" and "state of the glottis".

Manner of articulation	State of the glottis		Place of articulation
	Voiceless	Voiced	
Stop (plosives)	p t k	b d g	Bilabial Alveolar Velar
Fricative	f θ s ʃ h	v ð z ʒ	Labio-dental Dental Alveolar Palato-alveolar Glottal
Affricate	tʃ	dʒ	Palato-alveolar
Lateral		ɫ	Alveolar
Liquid		l r	Alveolar
Semi-vowel		w j	Bilabial Palatal
Nasal		m n ŋ	Bilabial Alveolar Velar

Stress

Stress means giving a greater power or force of volume to a syllable. It also means giving a higher pitch to this syllable and making the same syllable longer. These things together bring about a contrast between a stressed syllable and other syllables in the same words or phrase.

Syllable

A syllable is therefore that unit of a word that is pronounced with a single breath pulse. That is air rushes out of the mouth once. A one syllable word is pronounced. Examples are:

Mouth	Out	Jump	Both
Book	give	sleep	come

Fish	City	drive	shot
Go	loves	dance	but
Free	Make	hot	no

Types of Syllables

1. Monosyllabic
2. Bisyllabic
3. Polysyllabic

Monosyllabic

This refers to a word that contains one syllable. Every monosyllabic word takes stress completely because it is the only syllable. Examples: ~~Month~~ Book, Fish ~~Free~~ Go, ~~Out~~ Give, ~~City~~ Loves ~~Make~~

Bisyllabic

This refers to a word that contains two syllables with only one of the syllable. Stressed. Stress on such words therefore is placed on that syllable that is produced with greater energy during pronunciation. Therefore, bisyllabic word has one syllable sound that sounds louder than the other.

Words of two or more syllables have as unpredictable stress pattern unlike words of one syllable.

Attend	ABOVE	champAGNE
Busy	exPEL	River
Finish	Even	Ritual
SHOUTing	city	exAMPLE
HUNdred	CHARter	TRANSport
GREEdy	charADE	UNder

Polysyllabic

These are words which contain more than two syllable that is three four etc. we have not defined rules governing polysyllabic stress pattern. But some polysyllabic words end with -ing, -eg, -ly, -ial, -ion, -ian, or -ity while some may have prefixes like im-, mal-, pro-, and dis-

Words of three syllables

eduCATE imPudent

RHEtoric TOLerate

imPULsive liQUidize

Words of four syllables

disagreEment pandeMOnium

articulate PopulArise

PAlimony Palatable

COMfortable inVEStigate

conCEivable

Words of five syllables

conCESSIONary spirituAlity

Liberalism spinaBlifida

congratulAtion

Intonation

The ability of a speaker to allow the level of his voice to rise or fall results in what is called pitch. Pitch is capable of being modified in various ways to create the melody of speech when a person speaks; the pitch of his voice keeps changing; it may be high sometimes, it may be low at other times. This is technically referred to as intonation.

Types of Intonation

- Falling Tune

- Rising Tune

Falling Tune

The falling tune is defined as when the pitch of voice falls on the last stressed syllable in a normal speech. There is a fall in intonation when the speaker makes a statement, command, exclamation or a wh-question. Example:

- Sit down! Command ↘

- Stephen is a good boy. (statement) ↘

- Oh! My God! (exclamation) ↘

- What is your name? (wh-question) ↘

- Keep quiet(command) ↘

Rising Tune

The rising tune is when the pitch of the voice rises on the last stressed syllable in a normal speech. For instance:

- Is food ready? ↗

- I will BUY PEN, a WATCH and INK. ↗

Rhythm

Rhythm which is also known as isochrony is a unit in phonology that determines audible weight. In some languages rhythm determines stress or timing. It is also one of the three aspects of prosody, along with stress and intonation. Rhythm is both a feature of and product of the phonological structure.

Rhythm is therefore, the general movement of sounds in continuous speech.

CORRESPONDENCE

Correspondence can be defined as an art which involves the writing, sending and receiving of message. In other words, it can be defined as communication by letters. It includes letters, memos circulars, telegrams, fax, reporters and email.

Letter

A letter is a message or pieces of information hand-written, typed or printed for an individual or an organization.

Aspect of a letter :

A letter is made up of many parts. They are: address, date, salutation body of the letter and complimentary close.

(i) The address

This is the starting point of the letter. There are two kinds of addresses the writers address and the receivers address. The writers address is written at the right hand side of the writing materials while that of the receiver comes at the left hand corner in the case of the official letter.

(ii) Date

This indicates the day, month and year the letter was written and it comes immediately below the writers address.

(iii) Salutation

This is the complimentary greeting with which the writer opens the letter. The particular kind used depends on the writer's relationship with his correspondent.

(iv) Body of the letter

This is the most important aspect of the letter: it is in this place that the message is organized in paragraphs and conveyed to the receiver. The opening paragraph is in the form of introduction which is brief and composed in such a way as to impress and arouse interest.

- interest of the reader. It also serves as a keynote of the subject matter so that the writer knows what to expect and the last paragraph serves to bring a close to the message.
- (v) The complimentary close

This is the last aspect of the letter. The relationship between the writer and the receiver also determines the kind of complimentary close greeting that is used. In other words, the form of complimentary greetings at the beginning should rhyme with the complimentary close (subscription).

- (vi) Name

The name of the writer is indicated below the subscription for the official letter. The surname of the writer, his position and signature are included.

Formal Letter

Formal letters, also called business or official letters are written to discuss issues with organizations, individuals, government or cooperate bodies. In other words, they are written to persons in authority or officers who occupy certain positions in the offices.

Feature of a formal letter

- i. Formal letter bear both the writers and the receiver's address.
- ii. Formal letters commonly contain the salutation 'Dear sir' or 'Dear madam'.
- iii. Formal letters bear titles stating what the matter is about eg. Application for the post of salesman.
- iv. The language used in the body of the letter is formal and polite. The letter is short and straight to the point. The first paragraph states the purpose of the writing without expression of pleasantries. It can also refer to any previous correspondence on the subject. The second paragraph states the details of the subject while the third paragraph expresses the expected next line of action.
- v. The complimentary close is commonly 'Yours faithfully'.
- vi. The signature follows the complimentary close.
- vii. The full name and surname of the writer with his official position if any.

FORMAT OF A FORMAL LETTER

Federal Polytechnic,
P.M.B. 35,
Mubi.
Adamawa State
27th July, 2016.

The Executive Officer,
Roma Ventures,
P.M.B. 56,
Yola.

Dear Sir,

APPLICATION FOR THE POST OF SENIOR ACCOUNTANT

I wish to apply for the post of senior accountant officer in your organization.

I hold a Bachelor of Science degree in Accounting (B.sc) and a professional certificate of chartered Accountants of Nigeria (ICAN)

I am a thirty five (35) year old Nigerian, an indigene of Mubi North Local Government of Adamawa State.

I hereby attach photocopies of my credentials for your perusal.

I would be most grateful if any application is given a favorable consideration.

Yours faithfully,

Signature
Ahmed Mustaph.

Types of official letters

- Letter of application
- Letter of termination of appointment
- Letter of appointment
- Letter of promotion
- Letter of condolence
- Recommendation letter

- Letter of congratulation
- Letter to the editor
- Letter of query
- Letter of enquiry
- Letter of order
- Letter of remittance
- Letter of permission

Informal letter

These are letters that we write to persons that are close to us or related to us such people are well known to us and they also know you, this kind of letter therefore, permits the sharing of personal feelings, jokes and pleasantries. Thus they are also called personal or private letters

Features of an informal letter

- i. Informal letters bear only the writers address, followed with the date e.g.

Department of Accounting,
Federal Polytechnic,
P.M.B. 35,
Mubi.
Adamawa State.
27th July, 2016.

- ii. The salutation varies depending on the relationship or degree of intimacy between the writer and the receiver e.g. Dear Emmanuel, Dear Mummy, My dearest Emma, My dear Uncle John etc.
- iii. The language used in the body of the letter is ordinary or "every day common" therefore permits the use of contractions such as "I'm" for "I am" couldn't for couldn't etc. Also nick names, pet names etc. are allowed.
- iv. The complimentary close is determined by the degree of closeness and it also agrees with the complimentary opening. Examples: Yours loving daughter, yours loving son, for parents. For friends, yours sincerely and for general relations, yours affectionately, yours ever with love from etc.

Function of a Paragraph in a Letter

(A) Opening Paragraph: it puts the message of the letter to focus by establishing the context of the communication.

(B) Middle Paragraph: its length depends on the message of the letter. All matters that constitute the substance of the letter must be stated here in the effective and concise manner. The details must be set down in a logical and clear way.

(C) The Conclusion Paragraph: the closing paragraph summarizes the message of the letter in the concluding paragraph, the writer's desire is clearly re-inforced.

Similarities between formal and Informal

Formal letter

The writer's address

It has date

Salutation

It has the body of the letter

It has a complimentary close

Writer's name

Informal letter

The writer's address

It has date

Salutation

It has the body of the letter

It has a complimentary close

Writer's name

Difference between Formal and Informal

Formal Letter

Receiver's address

Title

Signature

Language is formal

Informal Letter

No receiver's address

No Title

No signature

Language is not formal

Characteristics/Style of

(A) Formal Letter

The formal letter is in recent time (owing to the use of ICT) is usually written in the blocked form, from the address to the last item.

Form of address: there are two forms possible, the open and the closed form in the open form, items of the address are left open (i.e. not closed with commas) until the last full stop. In the closed form on the other hand, each item of the address is closed with a comma before on the full stop. In the formal letter, the closed form of address is the most acceptable.

Language: the language of the formal letter is restricted, the use of of figurative expressions, flowery language and shortening of words is not allowed. The writer is expected to be as brief and straight to the point as possible.

(B) Informal Letter

Any form of addressing is allowed either blocked or slanted.

In addition, the address could be open or closed.

Language: the language of the informal letter is lucid. It is often conversational.

Memorandum

A memorandum is a written communication sent from one person in an organization to another or to a group of people. Memorandum is the plural form of memorandum, and is usually abbreviated as memo. And so a memo being the short form of memorandum is defined as a short reminder circulated to one or more people. The memo often circulates beyond the original recipient, it is necessary that it contains the names of the original writer and recipient. The reference number written at the top of the page assists in filing and in tracing the document when sought after.

Memo is an important means of recording the on going business of an organization. It may present information, outline and discuss problems, propose solutions to problems or state what decisions were made. It may state organization policy or make requests of employees. Different organizations have different memo forms but nearly all memos convey the following information:

- The date
- The sender
- The recipient(s)
- Subject of the memo

Usually this information is given in the upper left or right-hand corner of the first page. Sometime in place of the word subjects, we find the abbreviation 'Re' (regarding). Sometimes the positions or titles of the sender and recipient are given. In the case of a memo from one person to a group, just the sender's title is included.

Like letters, memos may indicate the person who wrote and the person who typed the message. In the lower left-hand corner, we sometimes find the initials of the writer.

Capital letters without periods are used and they are followed by a slash or colon and the initials, in lower case letters, of the person who typed the memo. As with letters, if copies are to be

sent to others, their names are also given at the left margin after the message. The names of these recipients are preceded by the word copies or some times by the letters cc followed by a colon.

Types of memorandum

There are virtually two types of memorandum.

- a. External memorandum
- b. Internal memorandum

External memorandum

As external memorandum is a prepared documents containing the opinion and suggestions of an individual or group of individuals to be presented to an organization or panel. For instance, the Government or an organization may constitute a panel (it may be adjudicated panel or an administrative panel of eminent personalities) to investigate the causes of an incident or happening(s). In order for the panel to get to the root of what actually happens, the panel may call for written memorandum. From interested parties or those with relevant information that will assist the panel. The memorandum that is submitted will be studied by the panel, to assist them in making their final recommendation to the body that set it up.

In writing such a document, there are some guiding features to follow. The report must contain:

- a. Introduction
- b. Background of the incident being investigated
- c. Fact of the matter as known or observed
- d. Recommendations
- e. Conclusion
- f. Names and signature
- g. Appendix if any

Internal memorandum

The internal memorandum is a means of conveying an information or request to a person within the same organization.

The major difference between a letter and an internal memorandum is that a memorandum is usually written without the individual address of the writer or the recipient's address. It does not also contain any salutation or closing remarks. The exchanged of pleasantries is not allowed in

The registrar has requested the department to send the annual leave schedules of staff for the 2014/2015 academic session of his office before January 15, 2015. please let me know in writing when you would like to take your leave. Just two different time in order of preference. I will try to give every one his or her first choice while assuring that there is enough staff on hand to keep the department functioning.

Please submit all leave request by 15th December.

Thank you.

Uses of memo

Memoranda are used to convey different types of message within an organization; namely:

- A. procedure to be followed
- B. policies to be implemented
- C. Change in established practices
- D. Clarification or confirmations, motivation or exhortation of staff
- E. Disciplinary action
- F. Request of assistance etc.

A memorandum can be written by:

(1) one individual to another individual on the same grade within a department or across department.

(2) By a senior executive to a body of staff at different levels in the organizational hierarchy.

Importance of memo

The most important aspect of the memorandum's application in an organization lies in its provision of a written record for retention, future reference and circulation.

Comprehension and Interpretation of Texts

Comprehension and interpretation involve the ability to read a given text and understand it to the extent that one can answer correctly questions arising from such a text. In other words, comprehension means understanding while interpretation involves expressing your knowledge of the text in your own words.

The topic sentence is the main idea in the text which indicates to the reader what is all about. While the supporting details in the passage developed and support the main idea in the passage.

CORRESPONDENCE

Correspondence can be defined as an activity which involves the writing, sending and receiving of message. In other words, it can be defined as communication by letters. It includes letters, memos, circulars, ~~telegram~~, fax, reports and e-mails.

LETTER

A letter is a message or piece of information hand-written, typed or printed for an individual or an organisation.

ASPECTS OF A LETTER

A letter is made up of many parts. They are: address, date, salutation, body of the letter and complimentary close.

1) The addresses

This is the starting point of the letter. There are two kinds of addresses the writer's address and the receiver's address. The writer's address is written at the right

None state of the writing material suitable
that of the receiver comes at the left
hand corner in the case of the official
letter.

ii
Date

This indicates the day, month and
year the letter was written and it
comes immediately below the official
address.

(iii) Salutation

This is the complimentary greeting
with which the writer opens the
letter. The principal or kind used
depends on the writer's relationship
with his correspondent.

(iv) Body of the letter

This is the most important aspect
of the letter. It is in this place
that the message is organised in
paragraphs and conveyed to the
receiver. The opening paragraphs
is in the form of introduction which
is brief and composed in such a
way as to impress and arouse the
interest of the reader. It also
serves as a bridge of the
subject matter so that the writer

knows what to expect and lastly postscript serves to bring a close to the message.

(A) The complimentary close

This is the last part of the letter. The relationship between the writer and the receiver also determines the kind of complimentary close greeting must be used. In other words, the form of complimentary greeting at the beginning should rhyme with the complimentary close (subscription).

(B) Name

The name of the writer is indicated below the subscription. Proper official letter, the surname of the writer, his position and signature are included.

FORMAL LETTER

Formal letters, also called business or official letters are written to discuss issues with organisations, individuals, government or corporate bodies. In other words they are written to persons in authority or officers who occupy certain positions in the offices.

- FORMAL LETTERS
- (i) Formal letters bear the sender's and the receiver's address.
 - (ii) Formal letters commonly contain the salutation 'Dear Sir' or 'Dear Madam'.
 - (iii) Formal letters bear titles stating what the matter is about, e.g. Application for the post of salesman.
 - (iv) The language used in the body of the letter is formal and polite. The letter is short and straight to the point. The first paragraph states the purpose of the writing without expression of pleasantries. It can also refer to any previous correspondence on the subject. The second paragraph states the details or the subject while the third paragraph expresses the expected reaction or a citation.
 - (v) The complimentary close is commonly 'Yours faithfully'.
 - (vi) The signature follows the complimentary close.
 - (vii) The full name and surname of the writer with his official position if any.

General POLYTECHNIC

P. M. B. 35

MUBI

ABIMARA STREET
27TH July, 2016

THE EXECUTIVE OFFICER,
REMA VGNUTRA, P. M. B. 56,

YOLA.

DEAR SIR,

APPLICATION FOR THE POST OF SENIOR
ACCOUNTANT,

I wish to apply for the post senior
accountant officer in your organisa-
tion.

I hold a Bachelor of science degree in
Accounting (BSC) and a professional certificate
of chartered Accountants of Nigeria
(CICAN).

I am a thirty-five (35) year old Nigerian
an indigen of Mubi North Local Government
of Adamawa state.

I hereby attach photocopies of my creden-
tials for your perusal.

I would be most grateful if my app-
lication is given a reasonable consideration

Yours faithfully,
J.

- Letter of Application
- Letter of Appreciation
- Letter of Termination of Appointment
- Letter of Appointment
- " " Promotion
- " " Condolence
- Recommendation Letter
- Letter of Congratulation
- Letter of Recommendation
- Letter of Inquiry
- " " Order
- " " Remittance
- " " Permission

Informal Letter

These are letters that we write to persons that are close to us or related to us, such people are well known to us, and they also know us. It's kind of letter therefore permits the sharing of personal feelings, ideas and pleasantries. Thus, they are also called personal or private letters.

USES OF AN IMPERSONAL LETTER

Impersonal letters bear only the writer's address, followed up in the date and

DEPARTMENT OF ACCOUNTING,
FEDERAL POLYTECHNIC,
P.M.B. 35,
MUGI.

ADMINISTRATIVE
27TH JULY, 2016.

(i) The salutation varies depending on the relationship or degree of intimacy between the writer and the receiver. Eg Dear General, Dear Mum, My dear Uncle Tom etc.

(ii) The language used in the body of the letter is ordinary or "every day" common talk. I therefore permit the use of contractions such as "I'm" "It's", "couldn't" etc. Also nicknames, pet names etc. are allowed.

(iii) The complimenting close is determined by the degree of closeness and it also agrees with the complimenting opening. Examples: Your loving daughter, Yours loving son, For pen pals, Friends, Yours sincerely and For general relations, Yours affectionately, Yours ever with love from etc.

FORMAL LETTER

- The writer's address
- It has date
- salutation
- It has the body of the letter
- It has a complimentary close

INFORMAL LETTER

- The writer's address
- It has date
- salutation
- It has the body of the letter
- It has a complimentary close
- The writer's name

DIFFERENCE BETWEEN FORMAL AND INFORMAL

FORMAL LETTER

- Receiver's address
- Title
- Signature
- Language is formal.

INFORMAL LETTER

- No receiver's address
- No title
- No signature
- Language is not formal.

MEMORANDUM

A memorandum is a written communication sent from one person in an organisation to another or to a group of people. Memoranda is the plural form of memorandum and is usually abbreviated as memo. And so a memo being the short form of memorandum is defined as a short reminder circulated to one or more people. The memo often circulates beyond the original recipient; it is necessary that it contains the names of the original writer and recipient. The number written at the top of the page assists in filing and in tracing the document when sought later.

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- Subject of the memo.

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at the very margin after the message. The names of these recipients are preceded by the word copies or some times by the letters CC followed by a colon.

TYPES OF MEMORANDUM.

There are virtually two types of memorandum.

a. External Memorandum

b. Internal Memorandum

EXTERNAL MEMORANDUM

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- b. Background of the incident being investigated.
- c. Fact of the matter as known or observed.
- d. Recommendations
- e. Conclusion
- f. Names and Signature
- g. Appendix if any

INTERNAL MEMORANDUM

The internal memorandum is a means of conveying information or request to a person within the same organization.

The major difference between a letter and an internal memorandum is that a memorandum is usually

written on the envelope the address of the writer or the recipient address. It does not also contain any salutation or closing remarks. The exchange of memoranda is not allowed in memorandum as the document goes into the official files and could be tendered at meeting or before a panel.

FORMAT OF A MEMORANDUM

A.

Name of Organisation
Internal Memo

From: ---

To: ---

Date: ---

Ref: ---

Subject: ---

B.

Name of Organisation
Internal Memorandum

From: ---

To: ---

Date: ---

Subject: ---